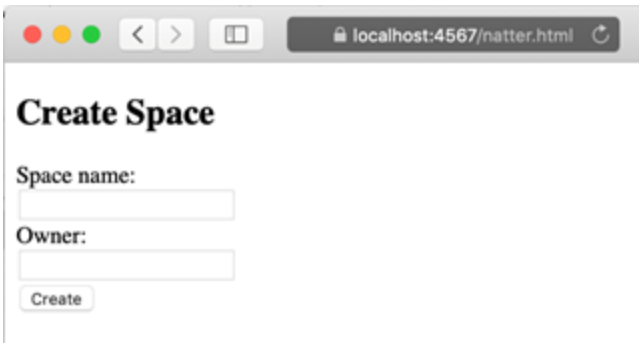


Figure 4.1 A simple web UI for creating a social space with the Natter API.

4.1.1 Calling the Natter API from JavaScript

Because your API requires JSON requests, which aren't supported by standard HTML form controls, you need to make calls to the API with JavaScript code, using either the older XMLHttpRequest object or the newer Fetch interface in the browser. You'll use the Fetch interface in this example because it is much simpler and already widely supported by browsers. Listing 4.1 shows a simple JavaScript client for calling the Natter API `createSpace` operation from within a browser. The `createSpace` function takes the name of the space and the owner as arguments and calls the Natter REST API using the browser Fetch API. The name and owner are combined into a JSON body and you should specify the correct Content-Type header so that the Natter API doesn't reject the request. The fetch call sets the `credentials` attribute to "`include`," to ensure that HTTP Basic credentials are set on the request; otherwise they would not be, and the request would fail to authenticate.